



Shruti Turner

UNDERSTANDING | MOVEMENT | STRENGTH

Rebuild Your Strength

How to train intelligently with
chronic illness, pain or injury.

Hi, I'm Shruti.



My Philosophy

Fitness isn't just about how much we can lift in the gym or how fast we can (or can't!) run.

It's about building the capacity to live our lives more fully, feel confident in our body and support our health.

To do more of what matters to us.

Too often, people are given oversimplified explanations for complex experiences.

Pain gets reduced to biomechanics. Fatigue gets treated as something to push through. One style of movement gets presented as the answer for everyone.

But our bodies are rarely that simple.

I'm a trauma-informed yoga teacher, Level 4 Strength & Conditioning coach, and I have a PhD focused on rehabilitation with training in neuroscience and biomechanics.

I also live with inflammatory arthritis, asthma and hypermobility.

Through both study and lived experience, I've learned that useful training starts with understanding the person in front of us and learning how to work with their body, not against it.

It's not about moving perfectly or following generic advice that ignores the reality of day-to-day fluctuations in pain, fatigue, stress or recovery.

The goal is not just to survive.

The goal is to build a body and life that allows you to thrive.

The Biggest Mistake

One of the easiest traps to fall into, especially when living with pain, illness or recovering from injury, is trying to follow fitness advice that leaves no room for your body, your life or your current capacity.

That can look like:

- doing too much on higher-energy days and paying for it afterwards
- trying to stick rigidly to a plan
- comparing yourself to people with very different circumstances
- feeling like you've "failed" when symptoms flare or energy drops

Over time, this can create a cycle of doing too much, needing longer to recover, losing confidence and questioning whether your body can be trusted.

The problem isn't that you're lazy, weak or unmotivated.

Often, the plan simply isn't leaving enough room for adaptation.

Your body and circumstances will change. Your training needs to be able to respond.

Let me be clear: You are not the problem. The programme may need to change.

Training With Your Body

One of the most important parts of rebuilding strength is learning how to work with your body, rather than constantly fighting it.

Our capacity is not fixed. It can change in response to pain, fatigue, stress, illness, sleep, recovery and the demands of daily life.

A change in capacity does not automatically mean something has gone wrong. It may simply mean your body needs a different approach today.

Some days you may have the energy and capacity for a full training session. Other days, your body may need a different approach.

Higher-capacity days might allow:

- longer sessions
- heavier loads or higher intensity
- more volume

Lower-capacity days might involve:

- reducing load, range or volume
- choosing a different exercise
- shortening the session
- switching the type of movement
- resting when that is genuinely what you need

The goal is not to force the same session every day. It is to keep making useful decisions with the capacity you have.

**Adapting your training is not “giving up” or “being lazy”.
Adaptation is a skill.**

Principles for Rebuilding

Start with what feels sustainable

Doing something you can return to over time will usually take you further than trying to do everything at once.

Progress is rarely linear

Symptoms fluctuate. Life changes. Setbacks happen. None of that erases your progress.

Adaptation is not failure

Adjusting your training to meet your current capacity is part of long-term strength building.

Rebuilding trust matters

Confidence in your body matters alongside physical strength and fitness, and both can take time to build.

Life is not a transformation challenge

Health, movement and strength are lifelong journeys, not short-term projects.

Rest and recovery are not the same thing

A day without exercise is not automatically the same as recovery. Sleep, nutrition, stress, workload and what came before it all matter too.

Adapting Without Stopping

Responding to your body does not have to mean choosing between doing everything and doing nothing. Often, you can change the session while still working towards the same bigger goal.

If today's plan doesn't fit, you can change:

Load

Use less resistance while keeping the movement.

Range

Work through a range that feels manageable today.

Volume

Do fewer sets, reps or minutes.

Exercise

Choose another movement that trains a similar area or quality.

Type of movement

Swap strength, cardio or mobility depending on what you need.

Rest

Sometimes stopping really is the useful choice.

**Different does not mean less valuable.
The goal is not to train the same way every day.
The goal is to keep supporting your body over time.**

Reflection

Take a moment to consider:

- What does “thriving” look like for you?
- What activities or experiences matter most to you?
- What would change if you trusted your body more?
- Where might adaptation help you keep moving instead of stopping completely?
- What is one useful thing you could do this week that feels manageable rather than overwhelming?

Small, sustainable steps still count as progress.

What Now?

Want help applying this to your own training?

My online coaching helps you build strength and movement around your body, capacity, goals and life.

Depending on the support you need, that might include personalised training, adapting sessions around pain or fatigue, and help building movement across your week.

Explore coaching:

www.shrutiturner.co.uk/coaching

You can also join me for workshops, retreats and movement experiences throughout the year.

www.shrutiturner.co.uk

@ShrutiTurner



Shruti Turner

UNDERSTANDING | MOVEMENT | STRENGTH